



POLICY BRIEF

PHASING OUT ASBESTOS IN INDIA: AN ACTION PLAN FOR HEALTH PROTECTION AND SUSTAINABLE TRANSITION BY 2030

Executive Summary:

- Asbestos usage in India is alarming, a very severe health concern for its citizens and environments, especially chrysotile cement roofing and asbestos pipes.
- India imports more than ~3 to 4 lakh tonnes of asbestos each year. Despite the domestic asbestos mining ban in India.
- Exposing asbestos-related diseases (ARDs) like mesothelioma and lung cancer to informal recyclers, workers, and communities.
- Projected around 6 million people are going to be affected by the ARDs in the next 20-40 years.
- The existing rules, such as the 2024 Quality Control Order, the Factories Act, 1948, and Model Rules, Hazardous Waste Rules, and NGT's 2025 orders, only control the use of asbestos but do not completely ban it. Zero enforcement in the informal sector and no plan for transition in the industrial sectors.
- This policy brief recommends a gradual phaseout by 2030. Asbestos ban in new public projects by 2027, give subsidy to alternatives, mandate retraining of workers, strengthen regulatory frameworks by the MoEFCC with enforcement by the state pollution control board.
- The International Labour Organization (ILO)/ Basel Convention commitments India can achieve, and can reduce asbestos-related diseases by 50-70%, and sustainable, climate-resilient buildings will be promoted.